AI for Business
Term: Autumn 2026
To be answered: In groups of up to five students
Main report: Maximum 8,000 words, excluding references and appendices
Attachments: Main report plus one consolidated appendix package
Presentation: 10 minutes, followed by questions
Submission deadline: Please consult Wiseflow

Designing Business-Facing Services for an AI Adoption and Innovation Centre

The challenge

A public authority is considering establishing or strengthening a government-supported AI Adoption and Innovation Centre. Your group acts as an advisory team commissioned by the responsible government or public authority. You will recommend which services the Centre should offer to the business and entrepreneurship community and how one priority service could be piloted. The Centre should help businesses and entrepreneurs, especially SMEs and new ventures, turn AI capabilities into concrete opportunities for productivity, new products and services, entrepreneurship, investment, and growth. It may provide use-case discovery, experimentation, skills development, access to expertise and infrastructure, project design and financing support, partnerships, and guidance on law, risk, and responsible use. The Centre should be practical and accessible to the business community, not primarily a policy or research body.

Your task

Choose one defined business context and one primary business client segment. Design a focused service portfolio that an AI Adoption and Innovation Centre could offer to this segment: two to three connected services, with one flagship service developed, prototyped, and tested. Conclude with a clear recommendation to the government on whether and how the flagship service should be piloted within twelve months.

Assume that the government intends to establish or strengthen the Centre. You are advising the government on the Centre's business-facing service portfolio, not on whether the Centre should exist. You are not expected to design an entire national AI strategy, a complete public institution, or a finished software product. The context may be a country, region, city, or sectoral ecosystem. Keep the project focused on one context, one primary business client segment, and one flagship service. In Part 1, briefly state your group's prior knowledge of or familiarity with the selected context, how this shaped your approach, and the limitations of the evidence available to you. Separate evidence, prototype findings, assumptions, and recommendations throughout.

MINIMUM SCOPE

- Select one defined business context and one primary business client segment, such as micro-enterprises in a municipality, SMEs in a defined sector, early-stage entrepreneurs, a sectoral cluster, or a business-support intermediary.
- Define one concrete business opportunity, adoption barrier, decision, or workflow problem. A broad topic such as "help firms use AI" is not sufficiently specific.
- Propose two to three connected services, but develop only one flagship service in depth.
- Sketch a prototype that demonstrates the central AI-supported mechanism of the flagship service. A complete software product is not required.
- Develop a practical value and operating case for the flagship service. Identify the main resource and cost drivers and the assumptions behind them; a detailed budget or financial forecast is not required.

Examples of possible flagship services

- An AI opportunity and use-case diagnostic for smaller firms.
- A product or service innovation sprint that helps entrepreneurs explore and test AI-enabled offerings.
- A skills and training navigator that helps managers to define role-specific learning paths for their employees.
- An AI product design, digital marketing, costing, and funding assistant.
- A sector-specific experimentation or pilot-support service.
- A matching service connecting firms with experts, data, computing resources, test facilities, partners, or finance.
- A responsible AI, procurement, and risk navigation service for entrepreneurs and SMEs.

These are examples only. Your group may propose another service if it fits the assignment and can be prototyped and tested.

PART 1: BUSINESS CONTEXT AND SERVICE PORTFOLIO

Define the business need and the Centre's service portfolio. Your proposal must:

- Briefly describe the selected context, primary business client segment, and evidence of the opportunity or problem. State your group's prior knowledge of or familiarity with the context and any important evidence limitations. Frame the proposal as advice to the government commissioning the Centre. State the Centre's role, boundaries, and value proposition in operational terms; do not develop a full institutional design.
- Propose a coherent portfolio of two to three services. Explain how the services fit together and which client needs or business opportunities they address.
- Describe how prospective clients would become aware of, understand, access, and move through the services. State the central value proposition, likely access channels, and main barriers to uptake; a full marketing or branding plan is not required.
- Briefly benchmark one other relevant initiative or programme. It need not be an identical centre; it may be an AI adoption programme, innovation hub, accelerator, test facility, training scheme, or other business-support service.

- For the benchmark, identify what can be transferred, what must be adapted, and what should not be copied into the selected context.

PART 2: FLAGSHIP SERVICE PROCESS, AI MECHANISM, AND PROTOTYPE

Select one service from the portfolio and develop it in detail. Distinguish the overall service process from the AI mechanism within it. AI must play a defined and meaningful role; merely advising firms to "use AI" is not sufficient. Your group must:

- Define the client organisation or entrepreneur, the person who decides whether to engage with the Centre, and the person who directly uses the service. Identify downstream customers or end users where relevant. Define the specific business opportunity or problem, the decision or workflow supported, the intended outcome, and one or more measurable success criteria.
- Compare the proposed AI-supported service with at least one non-AI alternative, such as process redesign, a rule-based tool, conventional training, a directory, or human advisory support.
- Translate the AI mechanism into a clear chain: inputs and data; AI task; model or tool; output; human decision or action; and feedback or monitoring.
- Identify the data, documents, or knowledge required. Explain their likely availability, quality, ownership, language, sensitivity, and update needs.
- Explain which AI capability is used, such as prediction, classification, extraction, generation, retrieval, matching, ranking, or multi-step orchestration, and why it fits the task.
- Build a working or demonstrable prototype. You may use existing AI tools, no-code software, spreadsheets, mock data, or code. You are not expected to train a model from scratch.
- Use a service blueprint or equivalent process map to show the client journey, frontstage and backstage activities, supporting people and systems, handoffs, human review, escalation, correction, and the points at which an accountable person makes or confirms a decision.
- Identify likely failure modes and show how errors would be detected, corrected, and escalated. Explain why the remaining risk is proportionate to the expected benefit.

Prototype requirement

The prototype may be simple, but it must demonstrate the service's central AI-supported mechanism. It may be a structured prompt workflow, retrieval-grounded assistant, diagnostic or matching mock-up, bounded agent, or data-extraction process *(these are examples only)*. A polished interface is optional; build only enough to test your main claim.

PART 3: PROTOTYPE TESTING, VALUE, AND OPERATING CASE

Test whether the flagship service works well enough to justify a pilot. Your group must:

- Simulate and document at least five structured tests: at least two typical cases, two difficult, edge, or failure cases, and one test designed to challenge the assumption on which the service most depends. Compare the results with the success criteria, record errors, and revise at least one element of the service or prototype.

- Obtain one perspective from outside your group through an interview, user test, expert review, written feedback, or structured review by another course group. The reviewer need not be located in the selected context. Explain what perspective the reviewer can provide and the limits of the feedback.
- Estimate the value created for the primary business clients and the responsible public authority. Where relevant, also discuss effects on downstream customers or end users and the wider business ecosystem. Use a small number of clear measures, ranges, and scenarios rather than false precision.
- Identify the main resources and cost drivers for a twelve-month pilot, such as people, data preparation, technology or licences, integration, outreach, training, human review, security, evaluation, and maintenance. Use indicative ranges or scenarios only where they can be reasonably supported, state the most uncertain assumptions, and do not produce a detailed budget.
- Briefly explain how the pilot could be resourced and what would be needed to sustain the service after the pilot, for example through public funding, partnerships, co-financing, or limited fee-for-service activities.

PART 4: IMPLEMENTATION, GOVERNANCE, AND FINAL RECOMMENDATION

Explain how the proposal could move from a student prototype to responsible operation. Your group must:

- Develop a twelve-month pilot roadmap covering preparation, launch, evaluation, and the decision to stop, revise, or scale. Indicate what additional capacity, partnerships, or controls would be needed for wider adoption.
- Identify the business functions, roles, and responsibilities required to deliver and integrate the pilot, such as service ownership, communication and outreach, technical development, data, client support, HR and training, partnerships, finance, legal and risk review, and monitoring. Explain the most important cross-functional handoffs and collaboration needs. Roles may be combined where appropriate.
- Identify the five to seven most important risks, including technical, operational, financial, legal, reputational, social, and vendor-related risks where relevant.
- Define four to six measures that would allow the responsible public authority to judge whether the flagship service is creating value and whether it should be stopped, revised, or scaled.
- Conclude with one of four recommendations to the government: pilot; pilot with conditions; revise and retest; or do not proceed. State the decisive evidence, the main conditions, and the unresolved assumptions.

EVIDENCE EXPECTATIONS

Use several kinds of evidence and make clear what each source can support:

- Academic concepts and research that clarify the AI mechanism, organizational problem, adoption challenge, or governance issue.
- At least one credible source closely connected to the selected context, such as a public authority, industry association, chamber of commerce, innovation agency, company,

or local research institution. You may use translation tools, but verify important interpretations and state any language limitations.
- Process evidence such as service blueprints or workflow maps, public documents, interviews, expert feedback, user tests, or service observations.
- Prototype evidence such as test cases, outputs, failures, comparisons, user or reviewer feedback, and documented revisions.

Do not cite a chatbot as an academic, legal, market, or contextual source. Do not fabricate facts, interview content, stakeholder feedback, test results, or financial figures. Where evidence is unavailable, label the point as an assumption and explain how it should be tested.

SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS

- Main report: maximum 8,000 words, including the executive summary and excluding the reference list and appendices. The limit is a ceiling, not a target.
- Executive summary: maximum 300 words, stating the context, primary business client segment, service portfolio, flagship service, main test result, value and operating case, and recommendation.
- Appendices: submit the required templates below as one consolidated appendix package, together with concise prototype evidence. Keep the appendices readable and avoid unnecessary material.
- Prototype evidence: include screenshots, sample inputs and outputs, workflow logic, and test results. External links may be added, but the submission must remain understandable if a link is unavailable.
- Presentation: prepare a 10-minute advisory presentation to the responsible public authority, followed by questions. Focus on the flagship service, prototype, strongest test evidence, value and operating case, and recommendation; briefly locate these within the context, service portfolio, and roadmap. All members must attend and be ready to answer questions. The group may divide speaking roles as it chooses.

USE OF GENERATIVE AI TOOLS

- You may use generative AI for brainstorming, translation, coding, prototype development, drafting, and stress-testing.
- You remain responsible for every claim, source, calculation, design choice, and output in the submission.
- Do not use generative AI to invent facts, sources, interviews, stakeholder feedback, test results, legal analysis, or local knowledge.
- Do not enter personal data, confidential information, or sensitive case material into an external AI tool. Use public, synthetic, or properly anonymized data.
- Document the tools used, what they were used for, the core prompts or workflows, and how outputs were checked in Appendix B.
- All group members must be able to explain and defend the prototype, analysis, and final recommendation.

Required Appendices

Complete the three templates below. You may adapt column widths or add rows, but do not remove required fields.

Appendix A: Prototype Test Log

Document at least five tests. Keep the entries concise; screenshots or fuller evidence may follow the table.

#	Case type	Scenario / input	Expected outcome	Observed result	Learning / revision
1	(Typical)	(Scenario or input)	(Expected result / criterion)	(Observed result)	(Issue, learning, and change)
2	(Typical)	(...)	(...)	(...)	(...)
3	(Edge / difficult)	(...)	(...)	(...)	(...)
4	(Edge / failure)	(...)	(...)	(...)	(...)
5	(Key assumption)	(...)	(...)	(...)	(...)

Appendix B: Generative AI Use and Verification

Complete this appendix even if generative AI was not used. If it was used, verify five material claims, calculations, design choices, or outputs.

Item	Your entry
Tools and versions used	(...)
What the tools were used for	(...)
What the tools were not used for	(...)
How AI-supported content was checked	(...)
Data-protection precautions	(...)
Dates of use	(...)

#	AI-supported claim or choice	Why material	Verification	Result	Correction / implication
1	(Claim, calculation, design choice, or output)	(Why it matters)	(Verification source or method)	(Verified / partial / no)	(Correction and implication)
2	(...)	(...)	(...)	(...)	(...)
3	(...)	(...)	(...)	(...)	(...)
4	(...)	(...)	(...)	(...)	(...)
5	(...)	(...)	(...)	(...)	(...)

Appendix C: Team Contribution Statements

Each member must add a statement of 150 to 250 words describing their contribution and one important learning from the assignment.

Member 1: (name)
(Contribution and learning statement)

Member 2: (name)
(Contribution and learning statement)

Member 3: (name)
(Contribution and learning statement)

Member 4: (name)
(Contribution and learning statement)

Member 5: (name)
(Contribution and learning statement)